

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 31, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 33:21-33

21 And it came to pass in the twelfth year of our captivity, in the tenth month, on the fifth day of the month, that one who had escaped from Jerusalem came to me and said, "The city has been captured!"

22 Now the hand of the LORD had been upon me the evening before the man came who had escaped. And He had opened my mouth; so when he came to me in the morning, my mouth was opened, and I was no longer mute.

23 Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying:

24 "Son of man, they who inhabit those ruins in the land of Israel are saying, 'Abraham was only one, and he inherited the land. But we are many; the land has been given to us as a possession.'

25 "Therefore say to them, 'Thus says the Lord GOD: "You eat meat with blood, you lift up your eyes toward your idols, and shed blood. Should you then possess the land?"

26 You rely on your sword, you commit abominations, and you defile one another's wives. Should you then possess the land?"

27 "Say thus to them, 'Thus says the Lord GOD: "As I live, surely those who are in the ruins shall fall by the sword, and the one who is in the open field I will give to the beasts to be devoured, and those who are in the strongholds and caves shall die of the pestilence.

28 For I will make the land most desolate, her arrogant strength shall cease, and the mountains of Israel shall be so desolate that no one will pass through.

29 Then they shall know that I am the LORD, when I have made the land most desolate because of all their abominations which they have committed."

30 "As for you, son of man, the children of your people are talking about you beside the walls and in the doors of the houses; and they speak to one another, everyone saying to his brother, 'Please come and hear what the word is that comes from the LORD.'

31 So they come to you as people do, they sit before you as My people, and they hear your words, but they do not do them; for with their mouth they show much love, but their hearts pursue their own gain.

32 Indeed you are to them as a very lovely song of one who has a pleasant voice and can play well on an instrument; for they hear your words, but they do not do them.

33 And when this comes to pass—surely it will come—then they will know that a prophet has been among them."

II. Key Summary

- A man who escaped Jerusalem told Ezekiel the city had fallen, and that evening God opened Ezekiel's mouth so he was no longer mute.
 - The Israelites still living among the ruins claimed they deserved the land because they were many, but God listed the sins they were still committing and declared they would die by sword, wild beasts, and plague.
 - The exiles loved to gather and listen to Ezekiel as if enjoying a skilled singer's voice, speaking words of love with their mouths, but their hearts pursued their own gain and they heard his words without doing them.
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III. Passage Analysis

Pleasant to hear isn't the same as taken to heart

They liked to listen to Ezekiel as anyone likes to listen to a good singer... They enjoyed the prophet's "music" but did not respond to his message with truth, faith and action.
[1]

The people genuinely enjoyed listening to Ezekiel—it moved them, it sounded good. But that feeling stayed in their ears and emotions and never turned into action. God isn't asking whether a message moved you; He's asking whether you actually did something about it afterward.

Being part of the crowd doesn't make you right

Many people today likewise depend on their connection with a group or organization, without seeking purity of heart. Yet it is purity of heart alone that will enable a person to stand in the end... in the final analysis, true religion is a personal matter. [2]

Those left in the ruins told themselves, "We're more numerous than Abraham ever was, so this land is obviously ours"—treating their numbers as proof they were in the right. But God was never looking at which group they belonged to or how many people stood with them; He was looking at the actual condition of each person's life.

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever said "I know" or "I'll change," while having no real intention of actually doing it?

Ezekiel 33 says God doesn't care how moved you felt while listening—He cares whether you actually did something about it.

References

- [1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-33/>
- [2] Chinese Christian Bible Study (ccbiblestudy.org), SDA Bible Commentary, <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT33.htm>